

α -labeling of banana tree graphs

Borna Gojšić

FER, University of Zagreb

September 9th 2025

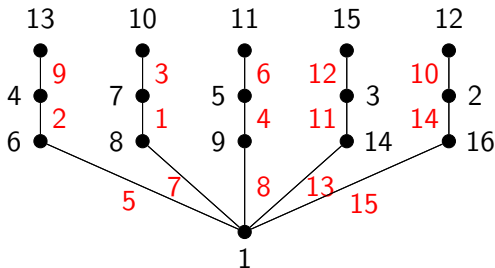
Sections

- 1 Introduction
- 2 Basic notions and results
- 3 Banana trees
- 4 Our results
- 5 Conclusion

- Fokus rada: α -**označavanje** i posebna familija stabala – banana stabla.
- Rosa (1967) uveo graciozno (β) označavanje i α -označavanje.
- Ringel-Kotzigova hipoteza: Sva stabla su graciozna.
- Primjene označavanja stabala: teorija kodiranja, teorija mreža.

Graceful labeling

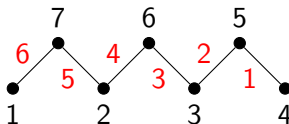
- $f : V \rightarrow \{1, 2, \dots, m + 1\}$
- $f^*(uv) = |f(u) - f(v)|$, $uv \in E$
- f^* must be a bijection to $\{1, \dots, n - 1\}$



Graceful labeling of a tree

- Additional property: there exists α such that for each edge uv exactly one inequality holds:
 - 1 $f(u) \leq \alpha < f(v)$
 - 2 $f(v) \leq \alpha < f(u)$

TODO: Mozda dodati kompleksnije stablo



α -labeling of a tree

Conjugate and reverse α -labelings

TODO: dodati Rosin remark o α -označavanjima

Definition of a banana tree $B(n, k)$

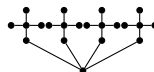
- Hierarchical structure: n star graphs S_k
- Each star is connected to a central vertex (root)



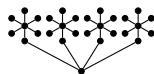
$B(2, 4)$



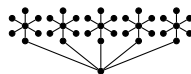
$B(3, 4)$



$B(4, 5)$



$B(4, 7)$



$B(5, 7)$

Symmetries of banana trees

TODO: dodati simetrije banana stabla

The set of labelings $B(n, k)$

Definition

Let $\mathcal{A}(n, k)$ be the set of all α -labelings of the $B(n, k)$ tree and $\mathcal{A}_x(n, k)$ be the set of all α -labelings of the $B(n, k)$ tree where $f(r) = x$. Let the set of principal α -labelings $\mathcal{P}(n, k)$ be defined as $\mathcal{P}(n, k) = \bigcup_{x=1}^{\lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor + 1} \mathcal{A}_x(n, k)$. Lastly, let the set of *central* α -labelings $\mathcal{C}(n, k)$ be defined as $\mathcal{C}(n, k) = \mathcal{A}_{\lfloor \frac{n}{2} \rfloor + 1}(n, k)$.

Proposition

Let f be an α -labeling of the $B(n, k)$ tree for any $n \in \mathbb{N}$ and $k \geq 2$. Then,

$$f(r) \leq \alpha \iff f(c_i) \leq \alpha \quad \forall i \in [n]$$

Partitioning $\mathcal{A}(n, k)$

Theorem

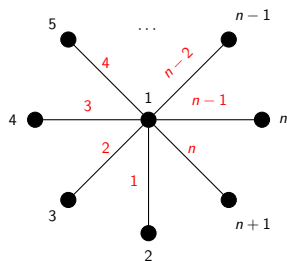
For every $n, k \in \mathbb{N}$, we have

$$\mathcal{A}(n, k) = \mathcal{P}(n, k) \cup \mathcal{P}^r(n, k) \cup \overline{\mathcal{P}}(n, k) \cup \overline{\mathcal{P}}^r(n, k),$$

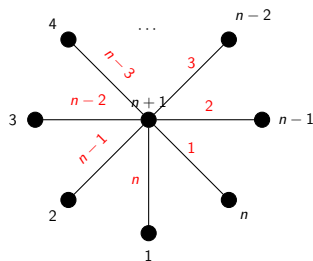
where $\mathcal{P}^r(n, k) = \{f^r : f \in \mathcal{P}(n, k)\}$, $\overline{\mathcal{P}}(n, k) = \{\bar{f} : f \in \mathcal{P}(n, k)\}$ and $\overline{\mathcal{P}}^r(n, k) = \{\bar{f}^r : f \in \mathcal{P}(n, k)\}$.

- Reducing the set of possible α -labelings by a factor of 4
- Reducing the complexity of the proofs

Classifying all the α -labelings of $B(n, 1)$ and $B(1, k)$ trees



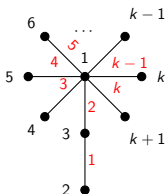
α -labeling f_1 of $B(n, 1)$



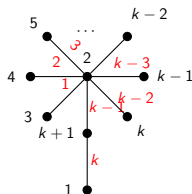
α -labeling f_2 of $B(n, 1)$

Figure: Two α -labelings of $B(n, 1)$

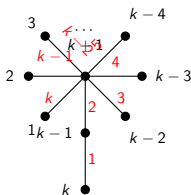
Classifying all the α -labelings of $B(n, 1)$ and $B(1, k)$ trees



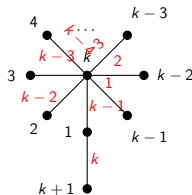
α -labeling f_1 with $\alpha_1 = 2$



α -labeling f_2 with $\alpha_2 = 2$

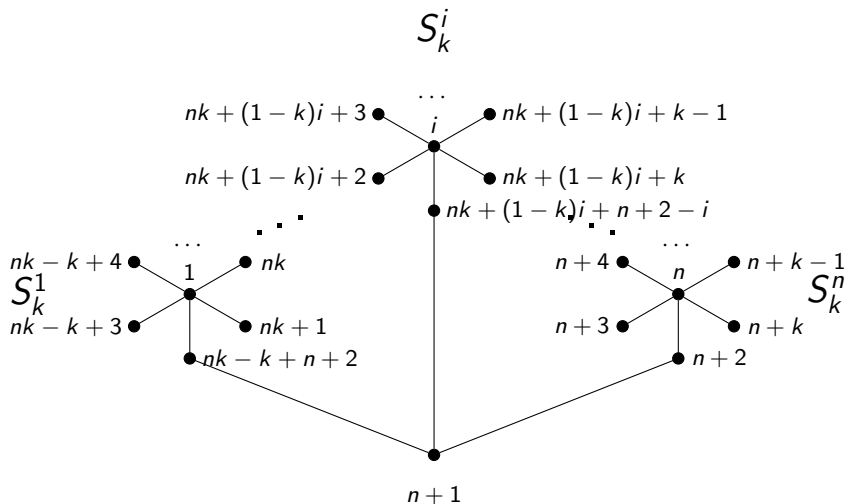


α -labeling f_3 with $\alpha_3 = k - 1$



α -labeling f_4 with $\alpha_4 = k - 1$

A sketch of the proof for $B(n, k)$ for $k \geq n$



A sketch of the proof for $B(n, k)$ for $\frac{n}{2} + 1 \leq k \leq n$

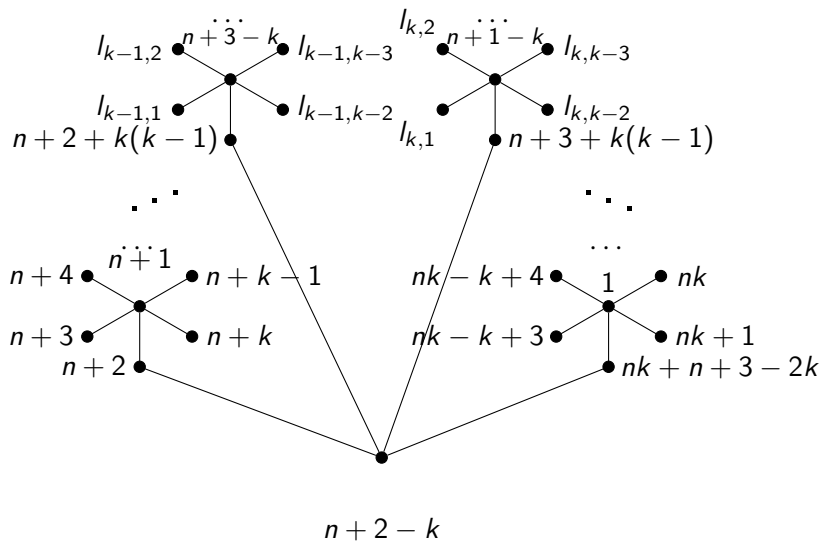
$$f(r) = n + 2 - k$$

$$f(c_i) = \begin{cases} n + 2 - i, & i < k \\ n + 1 - i, & i \geq k \end{cases} \quad (1)$$

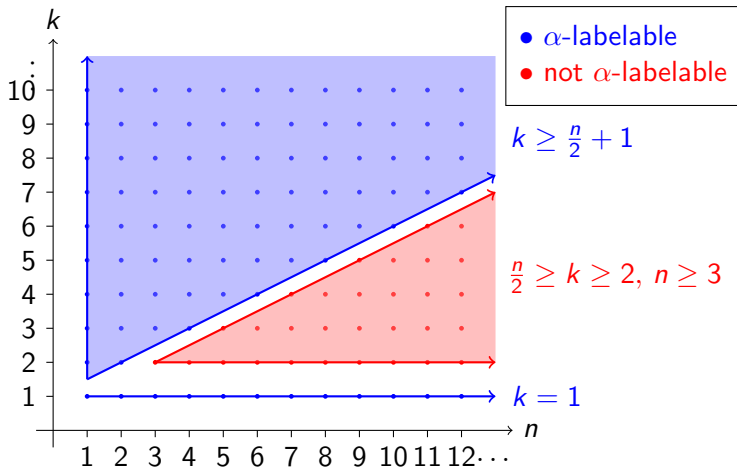
$$f(a_i) = \begin{cases} n + 2 - k + ki, & i < k \\ n + 3 - 2k + ki, & i \geq k \end{cases}$$

$$\mathcal{F}(\mathcal{L}_i) = \{n + 3 - k + (k - 1)i, \dots, n + 1 + (k - 1)i\} \setminus \{f(a_i)\}$$

A sketch of the proof for $B(n, k)$ for $\frac{n}{2} + 1 \leq k \leq n$



α -labelability of $B(n, k)$ trees



Conclusion

- We settled the open question of the existence of α -labelings for $B(n, k)$ trees for all $n, k \in \mathbb{N}$
- Introduced new notation and concepts for α -labelings of $B(n, k)$ trees
- Opened new questions regarding the number of non-isomorphic α -labelings of $B(n, k)$ trees for $n \geq 3$

Thank you for your attention!

Any questions?